NEW YORK, UNITED STATES

# Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum: Masterpieces

Twenty paintings move between recognisable things and arrangements that no longer need to name them.



A window, a seated man, a cyclist: these subjects give us something to find. Finding them is only the beginning. Chagall separates a face into incompatible views; Cézanne builds a body from adjoining patches; Metzinger makes a bicycle share its space with the track and crowd. Elsewhere, Kelly's coloured panels offer nothing to identify beyond their colours and proportions. These are different choices about what a painting can hold, not steps in a single march towards abstraction. This selection also crosses institutions: it includes works from the Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum in New York and the Peggy Guggenheim Collection in Venice. The Venice works are identified below; this is not a New York visiting route.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

## Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context  Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/guggenheim-new-york

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# Paris through the Window

Marc Chagall

1913 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Marc Chagall. Paris Through the Window. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The window promises a view of Paris, but its frame cannot keep the city separate from the inventions around it. A cat occupies the sill; a doubled face and floating figures disrupt ordinary relations of scale and gravity. Chagall leaves enough of the city intact for recognition, then gives the foreground rules of its own. Seeing through a window becomes considerably less straightforward than it first sounds.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 37.438

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# Blue, Green, Yellow, Orange, Red

Ellsworth Kelly

1966 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Ellsworth Kelly. Blue Green Yellow Orange Red. WikiArt source label: (c) Ellsworth Kelly, all rights reserved. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/ellsworth-kelly/blue-green-yellow-orange-red-1966 · (c) Ellsworth Kelly, all rights reserved (WikiArt source label)

Kelly sets five upright colour panels beside one another. Their clarity makes comparison unavoidable: the blue meets the green at an actual edge, and each colour has neighbours that affect its apparent strength. There is no depicted room or landscape to settle those relationships. The physical division into panels does work that a drawn outline might do elsewhere, giving colour its own measured extent.

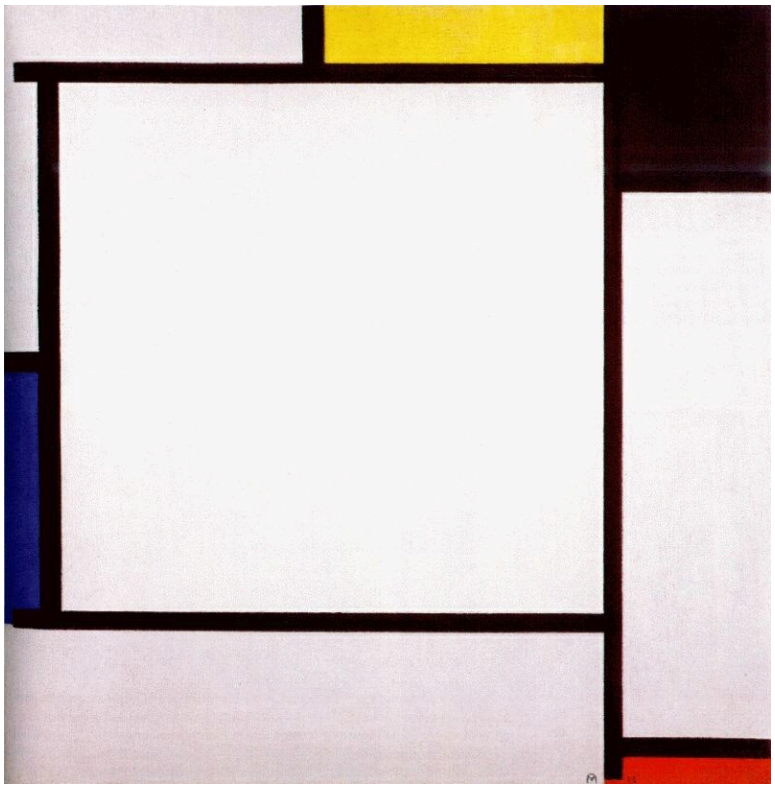
Object source · Open artwork

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# Composition No. 2

Piet Mondrian

1922 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Piet Mondrian. Composition 2. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/piet-mondrian/composition-2-1922 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Unequal rectangles prevent Mondrian's black grid from settling into a regular pattern. Much of the square remains white; smaller areas of colour exert pressure near the edges. Balance here does not mean matching one side with the other. Follow a line to the canvas boundary and then return to the larger white areas: the divisions keep changing the weight of what initially seems empty.

Object source · Open artwork

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# Enchanted Forest

Jackson Pollock

1947 · Oil and alkyd enamel paint on canvas · Peggy Guggenheim Collection, Venice (Solomon R. Guggenheim Foundation, New York)



Enchanted Forest. WikiArt; Jackson Pollock. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Jackson Pollock

Black, white, gold and red lines overlap without assembling into a single object. The open areas are important: they let individual strands remain legible within the web. Following one line eventually means losing it beneath another, so looking involves repeated starts rather than arrival at a central figure. This Pollock belongs to the Peggy Guggenheim Collection in Venice, not the New York museum.

Object source · Open artwork

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# The Tilled Field

Joan Miró

1923–1924 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum




Joan Miró. The Tilled Field. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Animals, plants, a house and flags provide the equipment of a recognisable rural place. Their changed proportions and improbable features make that recognition unreliable. Miró's yellow ground holds the separate inventions together, allowing the eye to pass from a familiar creature to a sign that resists a name. The field remains a place to inhabit, but its inhabitants no longer have to obey consistent anatomy.

Object source · Open artwork

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# The Hermitage at Pontoise

Camille Pissarro

1867 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



L'Hermitage at Pontoise. WikiArt; Camille Pissarro. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

Houses sit among trees on a slope, connected by the routes that pass through the settlement. Pissarro gives neither architecture nor vegetation exclusive control. Roofs interrupt the foliage, while trees partly conceal the buildings; the road makes their scattered arrangement intelligible. The landscape's structure comes from ordinary habitation rather than a commanding monument, with each small part contributing to a place larger than itself.

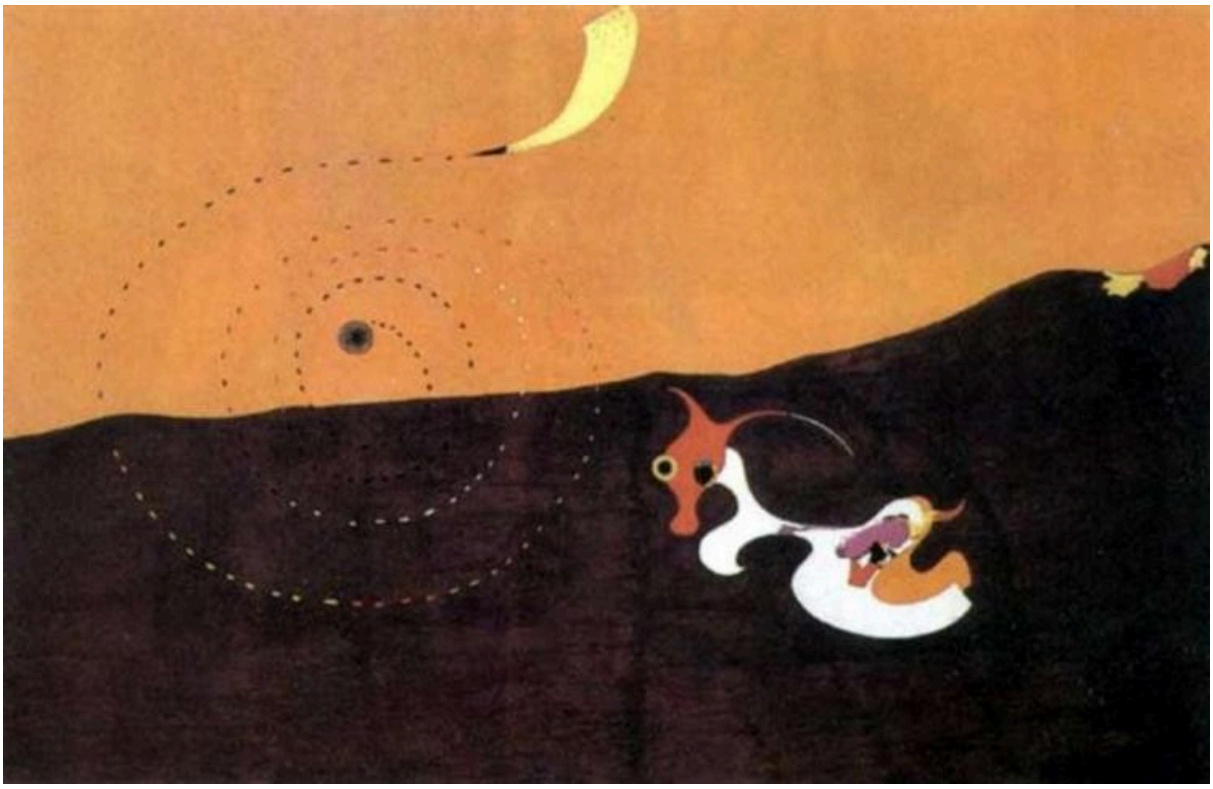
Object source · Open artwork

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# The Hare

Joan Miró

1927 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Joan Miró. Landscape (The Hare). Image: WikiArt. Copyright protected (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Copyright protected (WikiArt label)

A white, oddly jointed creature stands against orange, with a darker band below. There are few details to confirm the title, yet enough to keep recognition in play. Miró gives the surrounding colour much of the canvas, making the animal's sparse outline unusually exposed. Compared with the crowded inventions of The Tilled Field, this painting tests how little a subject needs in order to persist.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 57.1459

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# Landscape with Rain

Wassily Kandinsky

1913 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Wassily Kandinsky. Landscape with Rain. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/wassily-kandinsky/landscape-with-rain-1913 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Slanting marks suggest rainfall, while brighter and darker areas offer uncertain hints of hills and buildings. Kandinsky does not provide a stable viewpoint from which to reconstruct them. The diagonals let weather become a movement across the surface, affecting forms that are already difficult to separate. The title supplies a foothold, but the painting does not require every patch of colour to become part of a map.

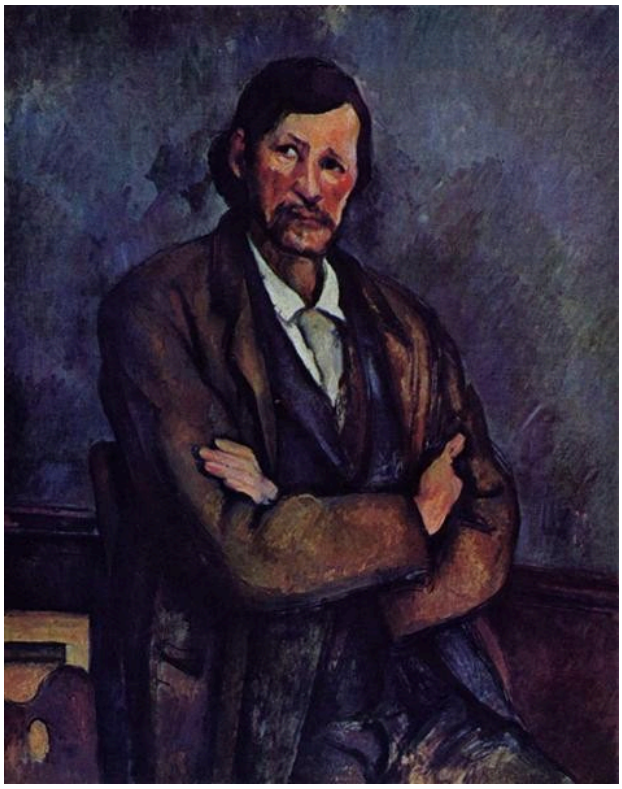
Object source · Open artwork

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# Man with Crossed Arms

Paul Cézanne

1900 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Man with Crossed Arms. WikiArt; Paul Cézanne. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The folded arms give Cézanne's sitter a compact shape, while the tilted head slightly unsettles its firmness. Patches of colour build the blue coat and face without disappearing into a smooth imitation of fabric and skin. The man remains solidly present, yet the means of constructing him are also visible. His apparent stillness depends on many small adjustments between neighbouring areas of paint.

Object source · Open artwork

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# Nude

Amedeo Modigliani

1917 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Nude. WikiArt; Amedeo Modigliani. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The reclining body occupies the picture closely enough to leave little room for a surrounding interior. Modigliani's continuous contours hold the warm flesh apart from the darker setting. With furnishings reduced, there is less to distract from the relation between the figure's extended shape and the canvas edges. The pose can be read at once, but its containment within the rectangle remains conspicuous.

Object source · Open artwork

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# Ocean Greyness

Jackson Pollock

1953 · Oil · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Ocean Greyness. WikiArt; Jackson Pollock. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Jackson Pollock

Black curves separate pale forms from a grey field. Some passages suggest eyes or fragments of bodies, though none resolves the whole painting into a single figure. Pollock makes recognition local and temporary: a shape can resemble something without determining what lies beside it. Despite the title, there is no dependable horizon dividing water from sky. The surface offers changing encounters rather than a distant view.

Object source · Open artwork

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# The Artillerymen

Henri Rousseau

1893 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Henri Rousseau. The Artillerymen. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/henri-rousseau/the-artillerymen-1893 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Uniformed men gather around a cannon beneath trees, their faces individually distinct within the repeated arrangement of bodies. Rousseau presents military equipment without the movement of battle. The men's assembly gives the scene its order; the cannon identifies their role but does not supply an event. That suspension allows attention to fall on the peculiar relation between separate people and a group made to look coherent.

Object source · Open artwork

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# The Soldier Drinks

Marc Chagall

1911–1912 · Oil on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum




Marc Chagall. The Soldier Drinks. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

A soldier, a drinking vessel and a table establish an ordinary action. Around them, tilted forms and differently scaled figures make the room difficult to measure. Chagall keeps the action readable while loosening the setting that would normally explain it. The vessel anchors the subject more securely than any consistent perspective; a small familiar object holds together a space whose other parts seem to belong to different systems.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 49.1211

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# Three Studies for a Crucifixion

Francis Bacon

1962 · Oil and sand on canvas · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Francis Bacon. Three Studies for a Crucifixion. WikiArt source label: Francis Bacon Fair Use. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/francis-bacon/three-studies-for-a-crucifixion-1962 · Francis Bacon Fair Use (WikiArt source label)

The three panels divide Bacon's bodies and meat-like forms rather than gathering them into one continuous scene. Bright orange and red settings make the pale flesh difficult to overlook. Fragments of rooms provide a partial framework, but the title does not resolve the images into an ordinary religious narrative. Comparison across the gaps becomes part of the experience: separate arrangements repeat the body's exposure without repeating a single event.

Object source · Open artwork

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# New Harmony

Paul Klee

1936 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Paul Klee. New Harmony. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Klee's rectangles suggest a grid, but their unequal proportions prevent mechanical repetition. Muted colours and darker divisions give individual units different weights. The title's harmony can be tested in these adjustments: order survives without requiring every part to match. Moving between a small rectangle and its larger neighbour changes the pace of looking, much as an irregular interval alters an otherwise steady sequence.

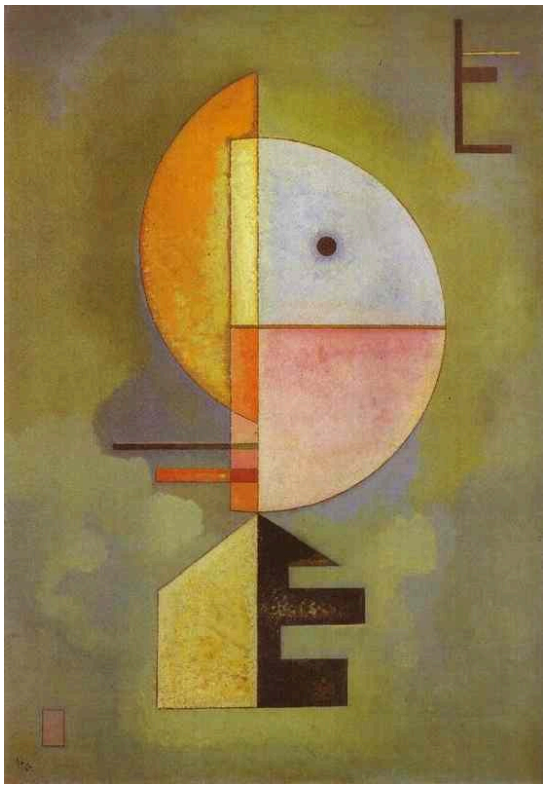
Object source · Open artwork

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# Upward

Wassily Kandinsky

October 1929 · Oil on cardboard · Peggy Guggenheim Collection, Venice (Solomon R. Guggenheim Foundation, New York)



Wassily Kandinsky. Upward. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/wassily-kandinsky/upward-1929 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

A narrow vertical line supports arrangements of semicircular and angular shapes. Their off-centre balance suggests both a constructed figure and an upward movement, without committing entirely to either. Kandinsky gives the turquoise-green field room to separate the parts, making their precarious connections easy to follow. The painting belongs to the Peggy Guggenheim Collection in Venice; the Foundation's New York address should not be mistaken for its collection location.

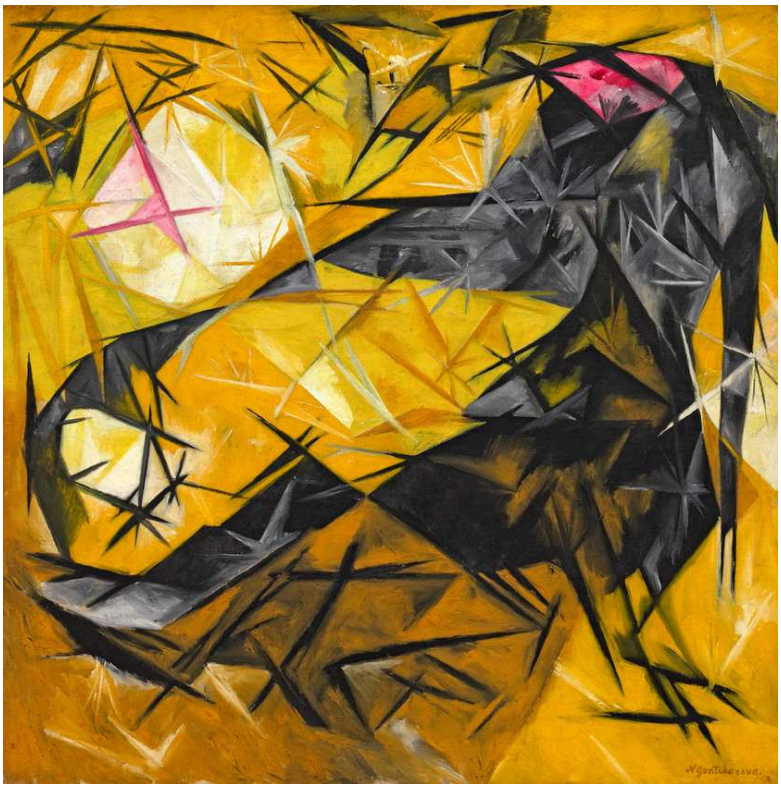
Object source · Open artwork

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# Cats

Natalia Goncharova

1913 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Natalia Goncharova. Cats (rayist percep.[tion] in rose, black, and yellow). Image credit: Natalia Goncharova. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Yellow, pink and dark diagonals cross the surface so insistently that the cats are difficult to isolate. Goncharova does not simply place animals against a background: intersecting marks pass through the distinction between them. The title encourages a search for bodies, while the lines offer a competing way to organise the picture. Neither reading needs to eliminate the other for the tension to remain productive.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 57.1484

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# At the Cycle-Race Track

Jean Metzinger

1912 · Peggy Guggenheim Collection, Venice




Jean Metzinger. At the Cycle-Race Track. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The cyclist and wheels remain identifiable amid fragmented forms, lettering and glimpses of the surrounding track. Metzinger brings information from different parts of the event into close contact, reducing the separation between rider and setting. Speed becomes a problem of how much a picture can show together, rather than a blur added to an otherwise stable view. This work is in the Peggy Guggenheim Collection, Venice.

Object source · Open artwork

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# The Steer

Franz Marc

1911 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Franz Marc. The Steer (The Bull). Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The pale animal curls into a landscape built from green, red and blue forms. Marc gives the body and its surroundings related curves, so the steer seems fitted into the setting rather than placed on top of it. Colour still distinguishes one area from another, but shared shapes connect them. The animal's compact posture becomes a way of organising the land immediately around it.

Object source · Open artwork

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# Windows Open Simultaneously

Robert Delaunay

1912 · Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum



Robert Delaunay. Simultaneous Windows (2nd Motif, 1st Part). WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/robert-delaunay/simultaneous-windows-2nd-motif-1st-part · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Overlapping blue, green, yellow and red areas retain suggestions of windows and a city without settling into a single view. Delaunay lets those hints compete with colour's ability to create divisions and connections of its own. The window no longer serves only as a transparent opening. Its edges and the things seen through it become material for a surface that asks to be read in several directions.

Object source · Open artwork

# Compare pictures before planning a visit

Kelly's panels and Chagall's window offer useful limits for this selection: colour with no depicted object, and objects that refuse a consistent world. The other works occupy varied positions between them. For travel, check each museum's current records separately. Enchanted Forest, Upward and At the Cycle-Race Track belong to the Venice collection; none of these entries guarantees that a work is on display.

# Further reading

## Concerning the Spiritual in Art

Wassily Kandinsky; translated by Michael Sadleir · Read free · English

Kandinsky’s own writing sets out his ideas about colour and form. Read it beside the two paintings here as an artist’s argument, rather than as a rule that every abstract work must follow.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12